



The Keepswell User Guide

A complete walkthrough of what Keepswell does, how it works, and how to use it on the web, on iOS, and over text.

[Get started → keepswell.com](https://keepswell.com) · [Read online → keepswell.com/how-it-works](https://keepswell.com/how-it-works)

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"The most common thing people tell us: they didn't realize how much had happened until they sat down and read it all in one place."

A note from us

Keepswell exists because so much of what matters gets lost — in group chats, camera rolls, and folders no one ever opens again. We built it to be the gentle, private place those moments can live, all together, and stay easy to find when you want them.

This guide will walk you through everything Keepswell can do. You can read it cover to cover, or skip to whatever you need. The whole thing is designed to be friendly to anyone in your family — including the relatives who would rather not download a new app.

Welcome in. We're glad you're here.

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◆ What is Keepswell?

Keepswell is a **memory-keeping app** that helps people gather the stories, photos, and small everyday moments that make up a life. You can think of it as a private group journal you share with the people who matter most — without the noise of social media.

You can use Keepswell on your own, or invite family and friends to contribute alongside you. Everyone responds when it suits them — by text message, in the iOS app, or on the website — and their memories appear together in one beautifully organized **memory book**.

♥ **Our promise.** Your journals are private. Your memories belong to you and the people you've invited. We don't sell your data, and we never will.

◆ Who it's for

Keepswell is for anyone who wants to slow down and remember.

 Families	Parents, kids, grandparents — invite everyone and watch a shared family story grow week by week.
 New parents	Capture the first smile, the first steps, the funny things your kids say — all the stuff you swear you'll remember but won't.
 Couples	Date nights, inside jokes, the trip you took on a whim. A private journal just for the two of you.
 Travelers	One memory book per trip. Drop photos and notes as you go, print or share when you're home.
 Milestones	Weddings, graduations, retirements, a year of recovery — invite everyone you love to share what they remember.
 Tributes	Gather stories from everyone who knew a loved one. A living tribute you can revisit, add to, and share.

◆ How it works at a glance

The whole experience is built around three simple ideas: a **journal** to hold the memories, **prompts** that gently invite people to share, and a **memory book** that turns all of it into something beautiful to look back on.

1

Create a journal.

Pick a template (Family, Friends, Romantic, Vacation, Celebration, or Custom), give it a title, and decide how often you'd like prompts to arrive.

2

Invite the people you want to share with.

Send invites by text or share a join link. Contributors don't need an app — they can respond by SMS if that's easier.

3

Memories arrive on their own schedule.

A short prompt goes out on the cadence you choose. Anyone can respond with a story, a photo, or both — whenever they like.

4

Read, react, and remember.

Open your memory book anytime to read what's been shared, react to favorites, and watch your family story take shape.

◆ Journals & templates

A **journal** is one collection of memories. Most people have a few — a family journal, a journal for each of their kids, a vacation journal, a journal for a big upcoming milestone. Each one has its own prompts, its own contributors, and its own memory book.

When you create a journal you start from a **template**. Templates set the tone, suggest prompts, and shape what the finished memory book looks like:

TEMPLATE	WHAT IT'S FOR
 Family	Warm, multi-generational prompts about traditions, milestones, and everyday life.
 Friends	Playful, story-driven prompts perfect for a group you've been close to for years.
 Romantic	Intimate prompts for couples about shared moments, gratitude, and the small things.
 Vacation	Short, in-the-moment prompts designed to be answered on the go, so a trip doesn't fade.
 Celebration	Built for milestones — weddings, retirements, graduations — with prompts that invite guests to share their favorite memories.
 Custom	Start blank and write all of your own prompts. Best when you have a very specific use in mind.

 You can change templates, edit any prompt, or add your own custom prompts at any time. Templates are a starting point, not a cage.

◆ Writing prompts

Prompts are the quiet engine of Keepswell. Each one is a short question or invitation — *"What's a small thing that made you smile this week?"* — designed to make it easy to write something honest in under a minute.

When you create a journal, Keepswell automatically generates a queue of upcoming prompts from the template you picked. **You're in full control of that queue:**

YOU CAN

WHAT IT DOES

Preview	See the next several prompts that will be sent.
Edit	Change the wording on any upcoming prompt so it sounds more like you.
Cancel	Skip a prompt you don't want to send.
Add	Drop in a custom prompt that matters to your family or moment.
Pause	Turn prompts off entirely if you'd rather write on your own schedule.

Prompts arrive on the cadence you choose — **daily, weekly, biweekly, or monthly** — at a time and day-of-week of your choosing, in your local timezone.

◆ Memories (entries)

A **memory** (or "entry") is one thing someone shares with the journal. It can be a written story, one or more photos, or both. There's no minimum, no formatting to fuss with, no word count to hit. **Anything you'd want to remember belongs.**

When you respond to a prompt, your memory is automatically attached to it. You can also add memories without a prompt anytime you have something you want to capture.

Other people in the journal can **comment** on memories and add **reactions** — small acknowledgments that say *"I read this, I loved it"* without turning the journal into another social feed.

◆ Contributors (participants)

A journal is more meaningful when other people are in it with you. **Contributors** can read every memory in the journal, add their own, comment, and react. Each one gets their own profile in the journal so memories stay credited to whoever shared them.

You can invite people three ways:

- 1. By text message.** Enter their phone number and they'll receive a friendly invite they can respond to right from their phone.

2. **By join link or QR code.** Share a link (or a code) that opens a simple sign-up form. Great for events.
3. **From the iOS app.** Invite people directly from a journal's settings screen.

How each contributor receives prompts

For every contributor, **you** choose how prompts reach them:

CHANNEL	BEST FOR
 SMS	People who don't want to install an app. Prompts arrive as a regular text.
 In-app	Contributors who use the Keepswell iOS app. Prompts land in the Prompts tab and as a push notification.
 Both	The best of both worlds — SMS first, also visible in the in-app feed.

 Owners can approve, pause, or remove contributors at any time from the journal's settings.

◆ The Memory Book

Everything you and your contributors share automatically flows into a **memory book** for each journal — a beautiful, readable view of every memory in chronological order, themed to match the journal type. Family books feel warm; vacation books feel breezy; celebration books feel formal and timeless.

The memory book is meant to be **read**. It's not a feed. You can open it any time on the web or in the iOS app and lose an hour flipping through what your family has shared.

 **Read it on a big screen.** The memory book looks especially lovely on a laptop or TV browser — perfect for sharing around a dinner table.

◆ Using the website

The Keepswell website at keepswell.com is the full experience — and the best place to manage journals, invite contributors, browse the memory book on a big screen, and adjust settings.

Signing up

Click **Get Started** in the header. You can create an account with your email and a password, or sign in with Google. We'll ask you to agree to our Terms of Service and Privacy Policy when you sign up — that's all the legal we need.

Your dashboard

After signing in you land on your **Dashboard**, which shows every journal you've created. Click one to open it; click **New Journal** to start another.

Creating a journal

On **Create Journal** you'll:

1. **Pick a template.**
2. **Give the journal a title** and an optional description.
3. **Choose whether to include yourself** as a contributor (and add your phone number if you'd like prompts by text).
4. **Decide whether to turn on auto-generated prompts.** We recommend leaving this on — you can always edit them later.

The journal page

Each journal has its own page where you can:

- Browse every memory chronologically
- Add a new memory yourself
- See and manage contributors
- Open the full Memory Book view
- Open settings to edit prompts, schedule, cover image, sharing, and notifications

Settings you can adjust

SETTING	WHAT IT CONTROLS
 Cover image	Pick from our curated set, paste an image URL, or upload your own.
 Schedule	Frequency, day of week, time, and timezone for prompts.
 Upcoming prompts	Preview, edit, cancel, or add custom prompts to the queue.
 Prompt library	Reorder the pool of prompts the journal can pull from over time.
 Notifications	Choose which events you want to be notified about.
 Sharing	Generate a public link so people can view the memory book without signing in.

◆ Using the iOS app

The Keepswell iOS app gives you the same journals and memories, designed for capturing things on the go. It's a great fit for quick photos and short voice-of-the-moment entries.

Getting the app

Search for **Keepswell** on the App Store and download it. Sign in with the same account you use on the website — your journals, contributors, and memories all sync.

Tabs

The app has three tabs at the bottom:

TAB	WHAT IT'S FOR
 Journals	Every journal you own. Tap one to open it.
 Prompts	Writing prompts waiting for you across all your journals. Tap Respond to compose a memory; tap Dismiss to clear it.
 Settings	Your profile, subscription, and account.

Capturing a memory

From any journal tap to add a memory. You can type freely, attach photos from your camera roll, or take a new photo right from the app. There's no save button — your memory goes live when you tap **Share**.

Push notifications

With your permission, the app sends a gentle push when:

- A contributor adds a new memory
- Someone comments on or reacts to a memory in your journal
- A new contributor joins a journal you own
- A new writing prompt is ready for you



You can turn each of these on or off **per journal** in journal settings → Notifications.

The Memory Book on iOS

Each journal has its own beautifully themed memory book view inside the app — perfect for handing your phone to a relative and saying *"look at all this."*

◆ Contributing by text (SMS)

Not everyone wants another app on their phone, and Keepswell honors that. **Anyone you invite can fully participate in a journal using nothing but text messages.**

How invites work

When you invite someone by phone number, they get a friendly text from Keepswell letting them know who invited them and which journal they've been added to.

REPLY	WHAT HAPPENS
YES	They opt in and start receiving prompts.
STOP	They stop receiving texts from Keepswell, anytime.
HELP	They get a short help message and a link to support.

Receiving prompts by text

When a prompt is scheduled, contributors who chose SMS receive the prompt as a regular text message. They can reply with:

- **Text** — turns into a written memory
- **A photo** — attached to the memory
- **Both** — even better

Their reply automatically becomes a memory attached to that prompt.

 **Why SMS matters.** A grandparent who doesn't want to install anything new can still share the story of how they met your grandmother — by text — and it lands in your family memory book alongside everyone else's.

SMS terms

Message and data rates may apply. Message frequency varies based on the journal's schedule.

Your mobile information is never sold or shared with third parties for promotional purposes.

See the full SMS terms at keepswell.com/sms-consent.

◆ Notifications & privacy

You're in control of notifications

For each journal, you can independently turn on or off notifications for:

-  New memories
-  New comments
-  New reactions
-  New contributors joining

Open the journal's settings and find the **Notifications** section.

Your journals are private by default

Only **you** and the contributors **you invite** can see what's inside a journal. We never make a journal public unless you explicitly turn on sharing.

What we do (and don't) do with your data

✓ WE DO

Store your memories so you and the people you've invited can read them.

Send the notifications you've opted into.

Back up your content in secure, replicated cloud storage.

Permanently delete a journal when you tell us to.

✗ WE DON'T

Sell your data. Ever.

Share your phone number or email for marketing.

Make journals public unless you explicitly share them.

Use your photos or stories to train AI without consent.

For the full details, read our [Privacy Policy](#).

◆ Sharing your memory book

When you want to share what your journal has become — say, at the end of a year, or for a celebration — Keepswell makes it simple.

OPTION	WHEN TO USE IT
 Public share link	Generate a link anyone with the link can use to view the memory book without signing in. Turn it off again any time.
 Direct invite by phone	Anyone you've added as a contributor can view the book anytime through their phone, no account needed.
 Read together on a big screen	Open the memory book on a laptop or TV browser to share around a dinner table.

◆ Frequently asked questions

Do my contributors need to download anything?

Is Keepswell free?

Can I have more than one journal?

What if a contributor doesn't want to be in the journal anymore?

Can I print my memory book?

What happens if I delete a journal?

Can I edit a memory after I share it?

Is my data backed up?

Can I change a journal's template later?

Can I turn off prompts?

Does Keepswell work outside the US?

◆ Getting help

We're a small team, and a real person reads every message.

 **Email**

susan@pikesquare.co

 **Support form**

keepswell.com/support

 **Read this guide online**

keepswell.com/how-it-works



Capture moments. Cherish life.

Start your journal →

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